AstroTaca Flat Panel quick start

Windows software 3.2.2 | 16 October 2026

Install and connect

1. Close NINA and AstroTaca. Run the **AstroTaca Setup** file supplied with your panel.
2. If prompted, choose **Install ASCOM Platform** and follow its window.
3. Connect USB and the power supply specified for your panel. Keep the cover's path clear.
4. Open **AstroTaca Flat Panel**. Select its **USB port**, choose **Save**, then **Connect**. The port is remembered.
5. If asked to calibrate, follow Set Closed and Open before using the controls.

Turn on the light

In the AstroTaca app: choose **Close**, wait for **Closed**, select a low brightness and click **Turn on / apply**. Moving the slider alone does not change the light. Choose **Light off** when finished.

In NINA: open **Equipment > Flat Panel**, select **AstroTaca Flat Panel (ASCOM)** and connect. Use its settings gear if you need to select the port. Choose **Close**, wait for **Closed**, then enter a low brightness and choose **Set**. Switch the light off when finished.

Close before requesting light. Opening turns it off. Keep manual controls idle during automated exposures. Disconnecting only the AstroTaca app leaves NINA connected.

Use the button

- **Quick tap:** open or close; stop while moving.
- **Hold 1 second, then release:** while Closed, cycle **Off > Dim > Medium > Bright > Off**.
- **Hold 3 seconds:** stop and turn the light off.

Set your levels in **Button settings**, then **Save to panel**. Dim is your starting brightness. Saved levels work without a computer; powering on keeps the light off.

Support the cover if it could fall. The motor releases after movement or Halt / release. Keep hands clear during powered motion.

Full guide, opening limits and help